

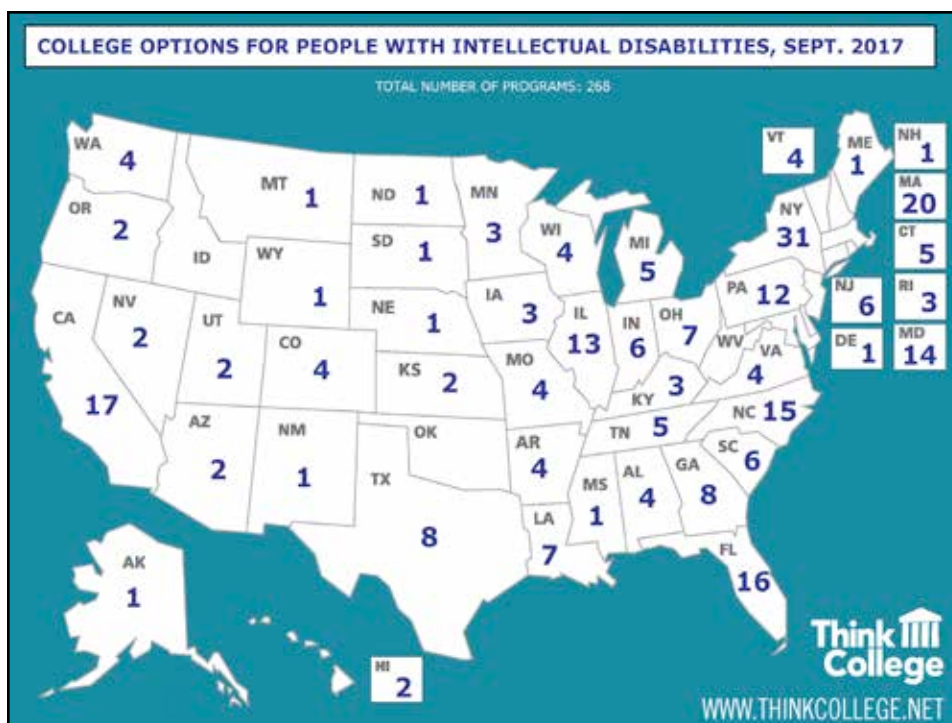


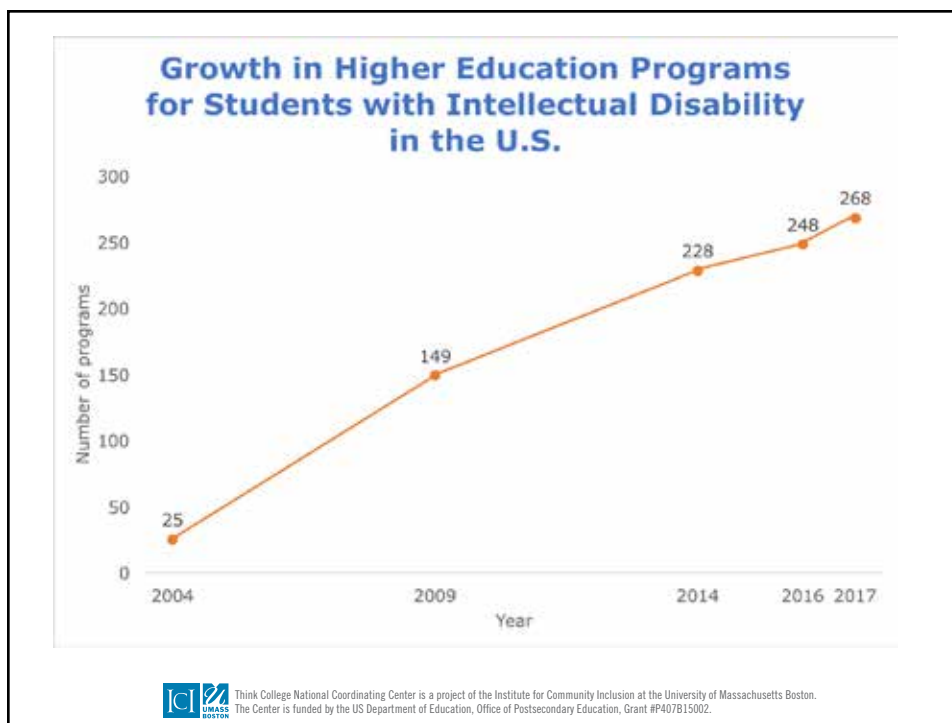
Inclusion Matters: Why & How to Create Authentic College Experiences for Students with Intellectual Disability

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 Think College National Coordinating Center
 Institute for Community Inclusion
 University of Massachusetts Boston
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 **ThinkCollege**
NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER

The Center is funded by the US Department of Education, Office of Postsecondary Education, Grant #P407B15002.





Higher Education Opportunity Act 2008

- Transition & Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disability (TPSIDs)
- Comprehensive Transition Programs (CTPs)
- Financial Aid eligibility
- Think College National Coordinating Center
www.thinkcollege.net

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Changing Expectations. Increasing Opportunities.

Think College is a national organization dedicated to developing, expanding, and improving research and practice in inclusive higher education for people with intellectual disability.

www.ThinkCollege.net

The Think College website is a trusted source for information, training, and resources related to inclusive higher education for students with intellectual disability.

The website includes:

- A searchable program directory to learn more about available college options
- A resource library that includes published research as well as field-created tools and resources
- Online learning modules on a variety of topics
- Research to practice briefs, e-newsletters, and journal articles
- Topical information on the critical issues
- A policy and legislation clearinghouse



College Options for Students with Intellectual Disability

Why inclusion?

- It's the law (all of them)
- Separate is not equal
- It's a civil rights issue
- Supports diversity in higher education
- Reinforces use of universal design for learning
- Impacts peers who are future neighbors, coworkers, family, friends

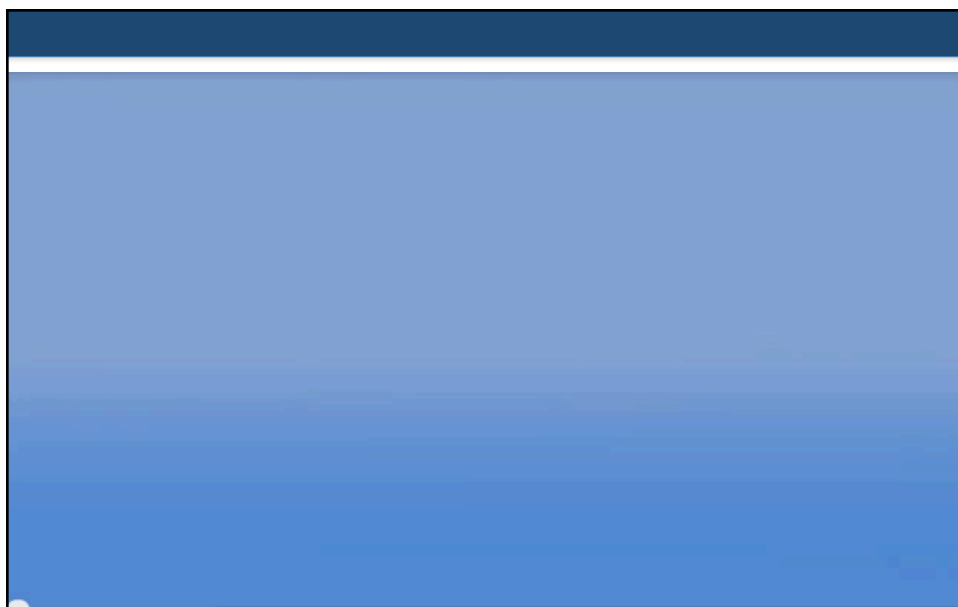


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“
To me, inclusion means that all people should be allowed to live fully without limitations and go places just as everyone else gets to go— like college.

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ACADEMICS



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Authentic College Course Access



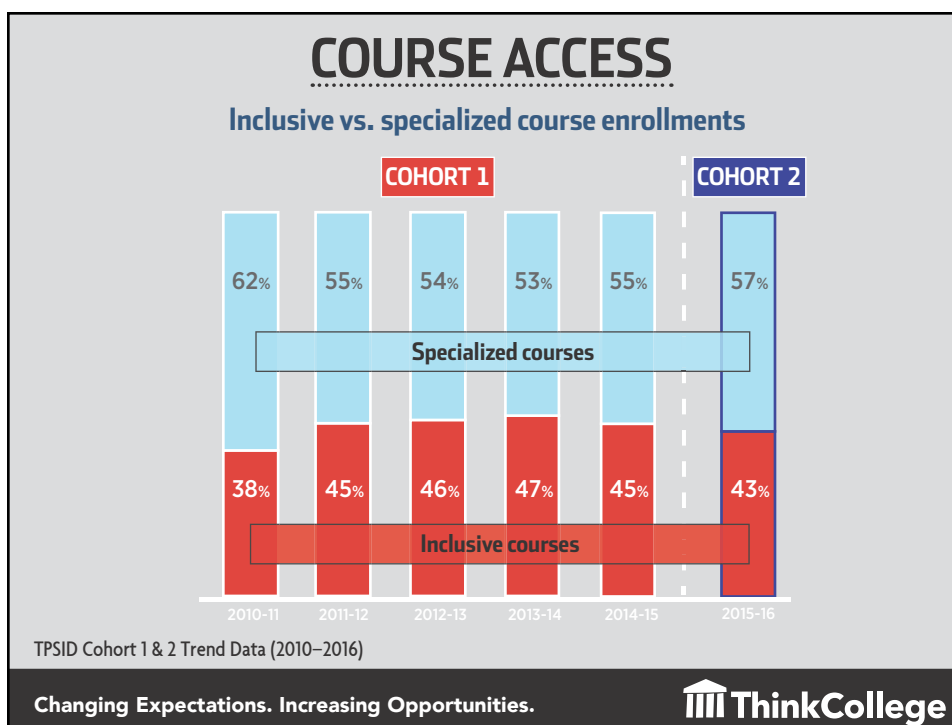
VS



Students with intellectual disability participate in inclusive college courses **'at least'** 50% of the time



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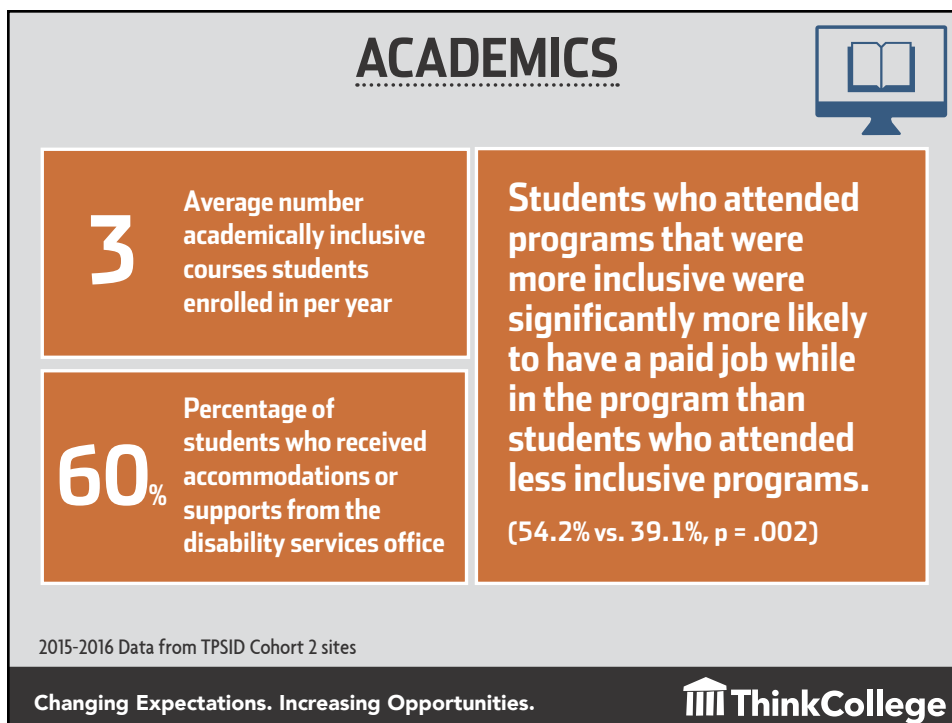


Why include students with ID in college courses?

- Broader array of learning opportunities
- Advance academic skills
- Advance engagement with college peers
- Established new future learning options
- Helps instructors build capacity and responsiveness to all students
- Exposes peers to diverse students
- Assists IHE in adhering to Mission Statement

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Other positive outcomes.....

- **Earn Credits:** students in inclusive courses were enrolled for standard IHE credit (54%). In most specialized courses (98%), students earned credit that could only be used towards TPSID credential.
- **Legitimacy of Credentials:** Students who primarily enrolled in inclusive courses in their final year were **MORE LIKELY** to earn a certificate available to all students at the IHE than students who primarily enrolled in specialized courses.



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Can they really succeed?



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Between 2010-2015

- Inclusive course access was established or broadened in most TPSIDs
- Over 10,000 inclusive courses were attended by students enrolled in TPSIDs
- 76% of these courses were taken for some type of credit

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“Students with ID, when given the expectation, opportunity, and needed supports and accommodations, **CAN** access college-level coursework, and, if desired, **CAN** earn college credits.”

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Tips to Keeping it Inclusive

- Curriculum is the course catalogue
- Keep to natural proportions
- What do students without disabilities do
- Whenever possible use existing IHE credential
- Priority or early registration for courses



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Inclusion isn't only about academics



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Tools to Keep it Inclusive

- Use Standards, Quality Indicators, & Benchmarks
- Similarity to typical pathway or experience
- Insight Brief: Building Inclusive Campus Communities
- Foundational Skills: teach skill in natural settings where skill will be used



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think COLLEGE! Inclusive Campus Communities: What do they look like?

All students are members of a heterogeneous student body in a college of their choice. They are welcomed campus members, active participants in academic instruction, experience reciprocal social relationships, learn academics in typical college courses and develop skills necessary for living an inclusive life in the community through learning experiences on campus. Supports are provided to students and faculty to enable everyone to be successful.

ACADEMIC ACCESS

CAREER DEVELOPMENT

CAMPUS MEMBERSHIP

SELF-DETERMINATION

Alignment with College Systems & Practices

Ongoing Evaluation

Campus Membership

Sustainability

Self-Determination

Collaboration & Collaboration

Inclusive Higher Education

As new postsecondary education options for people with ID are developed, errors of the past may be repeated, as segregated practices are developed that succeeding generations will have to struggle to alter. Postsecondary environments are highly valued, and many individuals and their families are thrilled to simply be allowed on campus. This sense of gratitude may lead to the acceptance of segregation at college, and slow or halt the advancement of authentic inclusion. (Uditsky and Hughson, 2012)

www.ThinkCollege.net
College Options for People with Intellectual Disabilities

How far have you strayed from the norm?

Similarity to Typical pathway or experience	Exactly the same	Harmonious adaptation	Noticeably different
Admissions			
-Forms			
-Processes			
Orientation			
Student records			
Student ID			
Program of Study			
Advising			
Class selection			
Financial			
Transactions			
-Courses			
-Activity fees			
-Room and board			
Transcripts			
Prerequisites			
Housing			
Graduation			
Credentials			

*Adapted from
O'Brien, Bowman
Chesley
Hughson, &
Uditsky



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INSIGHT

A Think College Brief on Policy, Research, & Practice

ISSUE NO. 26 • 2015



Building Inclusive Campus Communities: A Framework for Inclusion

By Melissa M. Jones, Molly Boyle, Cynthia P. May, Seb Prohn, Jean Updike, & Cade Wheeler

INTRODUCTION

This Insight Brief provides a framework for inclusion of students with intellectual disabilities (ID) in higher education. It was developed by members of the Think College Special Interest Group Building Inclusive Campus Communities and collaborating partners from the Institute for Community Inclusion (ICI). To support implementation of this inclusive higher education framework, a series of reflective questions are provided for practitioners and administrators that they can consider when designing new or evaluating existing

evaluation and refinement, so exploring what it means to be an inclusive college initiative is essential.

A COLLABORATIVE EFFORT TO PROMOTE INCLUSION

To address the need for a framework for inclusive practices, faculty and program personnel of several PSE programs in the United States formed a Special Interest Group (SIG). Building Inclusive Campus Communities, under the guidance of Think College, the national coordinating center for the federal grant supporting Transition Programs for Students with Intellectual

CHECKLIST FOR BUILDING INCLUSIVE HIGHER EDUCATION COMMUNITIES		
Definition of Inclusive Higher Education (Section 1)	Inclusion is a human right. It involves belonging to a community, having access to equal opportunities, being free to choose one's own life path, being actively engaged with and alongside others, and being valued for what one brings to the interaction.	
Questions for Reflection	Yes	No
Do students with ID take the same courses in the general course catalogue as other students on campus? (Check no if students take at least one course specifically designed for students with ID or choose from a limited list of courses.)		
Do students with ID choose their own courses, activities, jobs, and services with or without support? (Check no if program staff develop student schedules and opportunities.)		
Are students with ID physically on the same campus as students without disabilities? (Check no if program is off campus or on a separate campus.)		
Does enrollment of students with ID demonstrate natural proportions? (Check no if enrollment of students with ID at each campus setting exceeds the national average of 0.8%.)		
Do students with ID have access to all the activities and services available to other students? (Check no if some activities and/or student services are not accessible to students with ID.)		
Are students with ID enrolled at the college or university? (Check no if students are enrolled in a separate program located on or off campus.)		
Are students with ID governed by the same policies as students without disabilities? (Check no if separate or different policies for students with disabilities exist.)		
Do students with ID participate in the IHE's commencement/graduation ceremonies alongside their peers without disabilities? (Check no if students do not participate in commencement/graduation ceremonies or if a separate graduation celebration is provided to students.)		
Do students with ID live in campus housing alongside peers without disabilities if the IHE has campus housing? (Check no if students with ID do not have access to campus housing or if they are in separate housing.)		



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“TPSIDs that are more integrated into the infrastructure of the host IHE (e.g., registration, orientation, inclusive course of study) will have greater likelihood of continuing to support students with ID in higher education in the future”



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Bottom Line.....it's about.....

Having **HIGH EXPECTATIONS**
Believing in potential for success

Becoming life-long learners

Developing skills needed for adult life

Improving individual outcomes



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